

The Shared History Project

Who We Are: Haverhill Native American Commemorative Task Force

Commission: In 2022, Mayor James J. Fioretinni advised the Haverhill City Council that he was establishing “a Native American Commemoration Task Force” to plan and design the proper method of honoring and commemorating the culture and contributions of the indigenous inhabitants of this region to the history of Haverhill and the Merrimack Valley.

Charter: Our charter is straight-forward. Create signage, statuary and memorials that present an accurate and unbiased portrayal of this shared history.

Our Approach:

1. Signage. Create plaques, markers, story walk frames, and/or trail walker posts for trails parks, and memorial sites, such as rail trails.
2. Contribute to or expand the educational and commemorative aspects of existing parks with new designs, murals, statuary, signage or memorials.
3. To follow and incorporate the resolution and wishes of the Haverhill City Council to keep the Hannah Dustin statue in the city park, as well as to respect the contributions of the many citizens who participated in the discussion and committee hearings leading up to that resolution, and to effect such changes and adjustments as necessary to ameliorate any offensive objects, plaques or legends and to equitably incorporate the statue into this memorial.



The Native American Commemorative Task Force is seeking community support and input on how best to follow through on this memorial concept that not only honors the people, the traditions, and the history of Haverhill but provides lasting symbols of reconciliation, celebration, and aspiration.